

GOVERNMENT SECONDARY SCHOOL, GWARINPA

SS 1

ENGLISH NOTES

Word Stress

In English, we do not say each syllable with the same force or strength. In one word, we accentuate one syllable. We say one syllable very loudly (big, strong, important) and all the other syllables very quietly.

Let's take 3 words: **photograph**, **photographer** and **photographic**. Do they sound the same when spoken? No. Because we accentuate (stress) one syllable in each word. And it is not always the same syllable. So the 'shape' of each word is different.

Listen to these words. Do you hear the stressed syllable in each word?

3 syllables, stressed on #1
PHO-to-graph

4 syllables, stressed on #2
pho-TO-graph-er

4 syllables, stressed on #3
pho-to-GRAPH-ic

Some more examples are:

2 syllables, stressed on #1 and #2

	Noun	Verb
1	Object	obJECT
2	Import	imPORT
3	TRANSport	transPORT

	Adjective	Verb
1	PREsent	preSENT

2	PERfect	perfect
3	FREquent	freQUENT

3 syllables, stressed on #1 and #2

	Adjective	Noun
1	Delicate	disCUssion
2	FORTunate	oCCAasion
3	QUALity	proJEction

4 syllables, stressed on #1 and #2

	Verb	Noun
1	Accelerate	aPOlogy
2	Articulate	caPAcity
3	CONgratulate	deMOcracy

The syllables that are not stressed are weak or small or quiet. Fluent speakers of English listen for the stressed syllables, not the weak syllables. If you use word stress in your speech, you will instantly and automatically improve your pronunciation and your comprehension.

There are two very important rules about word stress:

1. **One word, one stress.** (One word cannot have two stresses. So if you hear two stresses, you have heard two words, not one word.)
2. **The stress is always on a vowel.**

Why is Word Stress Important?

Word stress is not used in all languages. English for example, use word stress and pro-NOUNCE DIF-fer-ent SYL-la-bles with more or less im-POR-tance.

Word stress is not an optional extra that you can add to the English language if you want. It is part of the language! Fluent English speakers use word stress to communicate rapidly and accurately, even in difficult conditions. If, for

example, you do not hear a word clearly, you can still understand the word because of the *position* of the stress.

Think again about the two words *photograph* and *photographer*. Now imagine that you are speaking to somebody by telephone over a very bad line. You cannot hear clearly. In fact, you hear only the first two syllables of one of these words, *photo...* Which word is it, *photograph* or *photographer*?

Of course, with word stress you will know immediately which word it is because in reality you will hear either...

PHO-to... pho-TO...

So without hearing the whole word, you probably know what the word is...

PHO-to...graph or pho-TO...graph-er

This is a simple example of how word stress helps us understand spoken English—especially rapid spoken English.

Where do I Put Word Stress?

There are some word stress rules about which syllable to stress. But...the rules are rather complicated! Probably the best way to learn is from experience. Listen carefully to spoken English and try to develop a feeling for the "music" of the language.

When you learn a new word, you should also learn its stress pattern. If you keep a vocabulary book, make a note to show which syllable is stressed. If you do not know, you can look in a dictionary. All dictionaries give the phonetic spelling of a word. This is where they show which syllable is stressed, usually with an apostrophe (') just **before** or just **after** the stressed syllable. (The notes in the dictionary will explain the system used.)

Phrase

A phrase is a group or combination of two or more words. It is a unit of a complete sentence. By itself, a phrase is not a complete sentence, as it does not

relay a complete thought. It does not contain the subject and the predicate both, so it is not a clause either.

The length of the phrase may differ from two words to many more words. This does not have any connection to whether it is a phrase or a sentence. For example “old dog” is a phrase. So is “the old, smelly, shivering dog” is also a phrase.

Types of Phrase

1] Noun Phrases

These are the phrases contains a noun- name, place or things and at least one modifier associated to the noun. The modifier can prefix or suffix the noun. The entire phrase will act as a noun for that particular sentence. Here are some examples;

- He was wearing a **black linen shirt**.
- They lived in a **small, tidy cottage**.
- Alex rode her **old bicycle** to their **shiny new school**.
- The **black car** got towed.

2] Verb Phrases

Every sentence will generally contain a verb. But sometimes the action being described requires a more nuanced multi-words verb phrase. The phrase consists of the main verb/verbs and then auxiliary verbs, i.e. helping verbs. Some such verb phrases are as follows;

- The teacher **is writing** the answer
- They **have been playing** since the last two hours
- You **must call** your friend at once
- He **has taken** the dog along

3] Prepositional Phrases

Any phrase that consists of a preposition and the object of the preposition which will be a noun or a pronoun is what we call a prepositional phrase. Such a phrase also at times consists of other modifiers describing the object of the prepositional phrase. Let us look at some examples;

- Students are advised to be **on time**
- Please turn **towards the right** at the intersection

4] Infinitive Phrases

A phrase that includes an infinitive along with a simple verb is an infinitive phrase. There may also be modifiers attached to the object in the phrase, it contains a verb, so it plays the role of expressing an action in the sentence. Infinitive phrases can act as a noun, adjective or adverb in a complete sentence.

- Alex likes to read comics (functions as a noun here)
- To attend the morning lecture, I set my alarm for 6 am. (noun form)
- To keep his dogs calm, Alex turned on the radio. (functions as an adverb here)

5] Participle Phrases

A participle phrase will begin with a participle, which can be a present participle (ending with -ing) or a past participle (ending with -ed). There may be a few modifiers and associated words included in the phrase. One thing to remember is that a participle phrase always takes the form of an adjective in a sentence. Some examples of the participle phrase are;

- We got a call from my aunt today **telling us the good news.**
- The house was severely **damaged by the flood.**
- Please sit down without **making a sound**

6] Gerund Phrases

Now a gerund is a word that invariably ends with “-ing”, without exception. So a gerund phrase is a phrase that contains an ‘ing’ word, with some modifiers in some cases. But participle phrases also have a similar pattern (-ing words), so how do you tell the difference between the two?

Well while participle phrases function as adjectives, Gerund Phrases exclusively function as nouns. Let us look at some examples,

- She is currently **writing her memoir**.
- **Washing the dishes** is Alex’s chore
- **Waking up before sunrise** had become his habit.

7] Absolute Phrases

An absolute phrase will contain a noun or a pronoun with a participle. Again it may also contain additional associative words and modifiers. An absolute participle will modify a whole clause, or even a whole sentence, not only one word. However, it does not constitute a complete sentence or a clause. Generally, an absolute phrase is separated by commas. Let us take a look at a few examples;

- He looked towards the beggar, **his face expressing pity**
- We were glued to the match, **our eyes always following the ball**.
- He sat on the bed, **his clothes neatly folded** by his side.

Vocabulary Development: Islamic Religion

1. **ALLAH:** *The name of the Creator of the universe.*
2. **AL-HAMDU LILLAH:** *Means all praise be to Allah.*
3. **AAYAH:** *Means verse of the Holy Qur’aan (also a ‘sign’ of Allah)*
4. **BISMILLAH:** *‘In the name of Allah’, this statement is usually made by Muslims who are about to indulge in a task.*
5. **DAJJAL:** *Anti-Christ*

6. *DIIN*: Usually translated as 'religion'. Diin is a comprehensive word which means a total way of life, following the commandments of Allah.
7. *DU'A*: Supplication: invoking Allah for whatever one desires.
8. *EID-AL-FITR*: Three day festival marking the end of Ramadaan – the 9th month (the month of fasting).
9. *EID-AL-ADHA*: The feast of Sacrifice. A four-day festival that completes the rites of pilgrimage and takes place on the 10th-13th of Dhul Hijjah (the last Islamic month).
10. *FAATIHA*: The opening chapter of the Qur'aan.
11. *HADIITH*: Sayings and traditions of the Prophet Muhammad
12. *HAJJ*: Pilgrimage to the Holy city of Makkah.
13. *HIJAAB*: Veil worn by Muslim women for reasons of modesty and protection.
14. *IMAAM*: A person who leads the prayer.
15. *IMAN*: Truthfulness, faithfulness and acceptance.
16. *ISLAAM*: Literally means 'submission to the will of Allah'.
17. *JAHANNAM*: Hell
18. *JANNAH*: Paradise.
19. *JIBRIIL*: Angel Gabriel.
20. *JINN*: A race of created beings that are made out of smokeless fire.
21. *KA'BA*: Holiest and first house of worship constructed for the worship of Allah.
22. *KHUTBA*: Sermon.
23. *MALAA'IKAH*: Angels.
24. *MASJID*: Mosque (place of worship for the Muslims).
25. *MUHAMMAD*: The name of the final Messenger and Prophet of Allah to humanity.
26. *MUSLIM*: Literally means 'submitter to the will of Allah'.
27. *QIBLA*: Direction in which all Muslims face when praying, which is the Ka'ba, in Makkah, Saudi Arabia.
28. *QUR'AAN*: The last revelation of Allah given to humanity, through his last Prophet and Messenger, Muhammad - peace be upon him.
29. *RAMADAAN*: The month of Fasting, the 9th month of the Islamic Calendar.
30. *SAHAABI*: Companion of Prophet Muhammad – peace be upon him.

31. *SAJDA: Prostration*
32. *SALAAM: peace*
33. *SALAAT: Prayer*
34. *SALLALLAHU ALAIHE WA SALLAM: Means 'may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him'. This phrase is recited whenever the name of the Prophet Muhammad - peace be upon him is mentioned.*
35. *SAUM: Fasting*
36. *SHAHAADA: The creed of Islam; 'I bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah, and I bear witness that Muhammad is the final Messenger of Allah.*
37. *SHAYDAAN: Satan.*
38. *SHIRK: Associating partners with Allah. The grave sin of Shirk is not forgiven if a person dies in that state.*
39. *SUBHAN ALLAH: Means 'Glory be to Allah'.*
40. *SUURAH: Chapters of the Qur'aan. Qur'aan has 114 Suurah or chapters.*
41. *TAWHEED: The Divine Unity, in its most profound sense. Allah is One in His Essence and His Attributes and His Acts.*
42. *UMRA: A lesser-pilgrimage to Makkah.*
43. *WUDU: Purifying with water before performing prayers.*
44. *ZAKAAT: Obligatory Charity*
45. *FAJR: Early morning prayer*
46. *ZUHR: Noon prayer (early afternoon prayer)*
47. *ASR: Late afternoon prayer*
48. *MAGHRIB: Sunset prayer*
49. *ISHA: Night prayer*
50. *JUMU'A: 'Friday', the Muslim's day of gathering on Friday noon prayers.*

Vocabulary Development: Medicine

1. **Anaesthetic**: a drug that causes temporary loss of bodily sensations.
2. **Blunt**: not sharp (used of a knife or other blade).
3. **Brace**: a support that steadies or strengthens something else.
4. **Cast**: put or send forth.
5. **Casualty**: someone injured or died in an accident.
6. **Ease**: freedom from difficulty or hardship.
7. **Filling**: any material that fills a space or container.

8. **Fracture**: breaking of hard tissue such as bone.
9. **Indigestion**: a stomach disorder characterized by discomfort or pain.
10. **Knee Brace**: a brace worn to strengthen the knee.
11. **Lotion**: any of various cosmetic preparations that are applied to the skin.
12. **Operating Room**: a room in a hospital equipped for the performance of surgical operations.
13. **Optician**: a worker who makes glasses for remedying defects of vision.
14. **Painkiller**: a medicine used to relieve pain.
15. **Prescription**: the action of issuing authoritative rules or directions.
16. **Prevent**: keep from happening or arising; make impossible.
17. **Recuperate**: restore to good health or strength.
18. **Sprain**: twist suddenly so as to wrench.
19. **Stiff**: incapable of or resistant to bending.
20. **Stitch**: a link or loop made by sewing, knitting, or needlework.
21. **Stitchery**: needlework on which you are working with needle and thread.
22. **Strain**: exert much effort or energy.
23. **Surgeon**: a physician who specializes in surgery.
24. **Surgery**: science treating disease or injury by operative procedures.
25. **Syringe**: a medical instrument used to inject or withdraw fluids.
26. **Syrup**: a thick sweet sticky liquid.
27. **Tickle**: touch (a body part) lightly so as to excite the surface nerves and cause uneasiness, laughter, or spasmodic movements.
28. **Tonsil**: either of two masses of lymphatic tissue one on each side of the oral pharynx.
29. **Tonsillitis**: inflammation of the tonsils.
30. **Tooth Decay**: soft damaged area in a tooth.
31. **Walking Stick**: a stick carried in the hand for support in walking.
32. **Wheelchair**: a movable chair mounted on large wheels.
33. **Prescribe**: issue commands or orders for patient.
34. **Reimburse**: pay back for some expense incurred.
35. **Reimbursement**: compensation paid for damages or money already spent.
36. **Slippery**: causing or tending to cause things to slip or slide.
37. **Shoehorn**: a device used for easing the foot into a shoe.

38. **Velvet**: a silky densely piled fabric with a plain back.

Creative Writing

Creative writing is defined as using words to convey emotion to the reader through imagination and invention.

Elements of Creative Writing:

- | | |
|------------------------|-------------------|
| ➤ <u>Action</u> | ➤ <u>Scene</u> |
| ➤ <u>Character</u> | ➤ <u>Setting</u> |
| ➤ <u>Conflict</u> | ➤ <u>Style</u> |
| ➤ <u>Dialogue</u> | ➤ <u>Suspense</u> |
| ➤ <u>Genre</u> | ➤ <u>Theme</u> |
| ➤ <u>Narration</u> | ➤ <u>Tone</u> |
| ➤ <u>Plot</u> | ➤ <u>Voice</u> |
| ➤ <u>Point of view</u> | |

Pronoun (possessive, Demonstrative)

Pronoun is basically a word used in place of noun or noun phrase. Pronoun can be viewed as a replacer of nouns in a sentence. In short, the word '**Pronoun**' means "**on behalf of a noun**", meaning that it stands for a noun.

Possessive Pronoun is used to show that someone owns a particular thing or to show that someone or something is related to another thing.

Possessive Pronouns are: yours, hers, mine, theirs, etc.

The functions of Possessive pronoun are:

- (a) Subject of verb
- (b) Object of verb
- (c) Complement

Demonstrative Pronoun is a kind of pronoun that is usually pointing-out or identifying specific things or people in a sentence.

Demonstrative Pronouns are: **this (these)** and **that (those)**.

The functions of Demonstrative Pronoun are:

- (a) Singular form, near reference

- (b) Singular form, distant reference
- (c) Plural form, near reference
- (d) Plural form, distant reference
- (e) Combination with nouns to form noun phrase

The positions in examples:

=>**This** bicycle is his.

=>**Those** tables are too dirty.

=>**That** bicycle is his.

=>**That school** has been closed down.

=>**These** tables are too dirty.

Verbs (Regular and Irregular)

A lexical verb is said to be regular if its past and past participle are formed by merely adding –d or –ed to the base or root form, while a lexical verb is said to be irregular if its past or past participle are formed in different ways.

Examples:

Regular verbs: arrive = arrived, achieve = achieved, attend = attended, call = called, carry = carried, etc.

Irregular verbs: shake = shook, bite = bit, choose = chosen, begin = began, eat = ate, tear = tore, drive = drove, etc.

Adjuncts (Types)

Adjuncts are adverbs which answer the questions – how, where, when, why, under what condition, to what degree, how often, for how long, etc. In other words, they are adverbs of time, place/direction, reason/cause, result, purpose, duration, frequency, comparison, condition and concession.

Examples:

They went to his house **yesterday**. (time)

The food is **on the table**. (place)

She was sacked **since she refused to apologise**. (reason)

He moves **proudly**. (degree/manner)

She stole the money **so that** she would pay her fees. (result)

He locked the door **in order** to shut-off air. (purpose)

He spent **two years** in this city. (duration)

Children **usually** cry. (frequency)

Michael is **wiser** than his brother. (comparison)

He will relay your message **if he sees** him. (condition)

They laughed **whereas I told them not to**. (concession)

Concord

The word 'concord' simply means agreement or harmony, it is the agreement which must exist between the subject of a sentence; whether noun, pronoun or its phrase, and the verb or its phrase.

The simple and basic rule is singular subject must carry singular verb, while plural subject must carry plural verb.

Examples:

The boy jumps/the boys jump

She likes eating/they like eating

Article Writing

Articles are written documents that focus on a massive audience to view and conventionally are published in newspapers, journals, books, magazines, etc. Hence, they are considerably shorter than other types of writing like essays or books.

Types of Article

Every type of article has its objective, writing style, and purpose. Some are published to consider public opinion, while others are used to inform people about certain topics. According to the purpose, article writing is categorised into four major parts.

1. Expository Article

Expository article writing focuses on explaining concepts and ideas precisely. It informs the public about the questions raised through information about the topic. The sole purpose of this article is to define the complex part of the information in a simple format.

Examples: “How to guide...”

2. Descriptive Article

Descriptive article elaborates and describes a specific topic, information, or event. This article's writing method demands the writer to explain it thoroughly with every minute detail. The article intends to offer the audience an accurate and reliable event picture.

Examples: Event descriptions, product reviews, etc.

3. Narrative Article

In this type of article writing, writer narrates a story of a topic, information, or an event. Here, the style of writing words should be highly engaging and creative. The key emphasis of the narrative article writing is to drive attention to the article and to offer an engaging experience to the readers.

Examples: Biography of famous people, fictional stories, historical events, etc.

4. Persuasive Article

Persuasive article is a style that can pursue the views of the user reading or against any information, topic, or event. Creating a hook with a catchy introduction and conclusion is also a part of this writing style. Persuasive writing methods include a convincing representation of an article. It also includes presenting facts and evidence with the topic, offering readers an argumentative opportunity.

Examples: Call To Action (CTA), Sales Pitch, etc.

How to Write an Article?

1. Choose Topic for Article Writing

A good article should discuss a core topic around which everything else revolves. The stronger the topic is, the less likely to move on a tangent while the writing process happens. For example, writing an article to promote a new product, like, ‘sleeping bag’. Without a clear focus, the article can be a collection of vague thoughts that can’t offer anything specific to the reader’s understanding. However, when article talks about ‘how sleeping bags can change the sleeping habits of infants’, it showcases the particular benefits or impacts the product makes for the specific target audience.

2. Understand the Audience

It is important to understand what and why before you write an article. Who is the target audience, what age group do they belong to, what respective professional backgrounds, or which industry do they fall under? All these questionable factors pave the way to making a perfectly planned article. These types of questions should be kept in mind before you get started. You should have a detailed understanding of your audience while you plan the article. With the audience and their behavioural patterns in mind, writer can gather a broad understanding of how the article should head.

3. Conduct Research

A well-laid topic research lets you dive deeper, explore valuable insights, and offer the audience reliable and accurate information. To build authority on your articles, ensure you select reliable sources — government reports, academic journals, or publications. Get into the minute details of your topic, understand different viewpoints, and decide on how valuable the article should be. Make a fact check, and give credit to the sources you cite in the article to increase reliability and trust. Also, conduct interviews with the subject matter experts for firsthand knowledge.

4. Create an Outline

An outline is an essential part that helps you focus clearly on writing and make the outcome clearer to the audience. The outline can be as simple as a set of subheadings/subtopics, or a long paragraph summary of the article. Another outlining technique is using mind mapping. Structuring an article works best when writer can classify it into similar sections. An article should have a clear introduction and a conclusion. If your introduction focuses on answering a particular query, the conclusion should list the summary points or broad ideas of the answers to that typical question.

5. Write the Draft

If one is writing a long article, delve section by section. Take breaks to refresh his/her mind and review the content written. Keep in mind what the article is about and stick close to the outline. If the writer needs to make any significant changes while writing, he/she get back to the outline, make the necessary changes there, and get an overview of how the differences reflect in the final article. After being caught up in the writing process, ensure one does not deviate from the article's core idea or forget who he/she writes for. Begin every section by tying back to the earlier section. Or begin each section by

referring back to the main topic or idea in the article. Mention sources while including statistics, facts, and figures from an external source. If one is writing an academic article, add citations.

6. Get the Visual Elements Ready

An article might not necessarily have visual elements. However, the visual elements, such as images, photographs, embedded videos, illustrations, and info-graphics, can improve an article. In the case of a long article, the visual elements can break the long sections of text, making it highly readable. Also, they can focus on the points made in the article. The decision on whether to accommodate visual elements or not in the article and the number of elements to include in the article depends on capability to create or source the visuals.

7. Revise and Edit

The work doesn't stop after writing the conclusion paragraph. Once the writer finishes his/her first draft, it is time to give article the space for a detailed review. Check the article for grammatical errors. Also, ensure the article is well-structured and every section seamlessly flows into the next. Put yourself in the audience's shoes while reviewing the article. Also, think back to your article's core topic and idea, and check whether you have stayed on track with the content. You may also get the article reviewed by another person, probably the team member or the proofreading expert for genuine feedback.

Format of a Good Article Writing

1. Title

A title grabs the attention in the beginning and persuades the reader to go through the article further. With a compelling title, writer can engage the audience and convey the significance of the article to the reader.

For instance, "10 Untold Facts About Artificial Intelligence that Leave You Shocked" grabs attention quickly, which forces the readers to go through the article and explore these hidden facts.

2. Byline

The next part is a byline, which appears beneath the title and beholds the author's name. It helps the author to earn credit for the content he/she has created.

3. Introduction

The introduction is as important as it offers a clear preview of the content, which makes the audience choose whether to read the article further. This is a gateway to the entire article.

4. Body

The part of the content that holds the entire soul of an article is its body. Here, the writer explains his/her views. It includes paragraphs, and sections that explain the matter. It usually includes the following elements:

Sections and headings: Dividing the main content into headings and sections improves the structure and readability of the article. It classifies the information, which makes the article more accessible and engaging.

Heading 1: Heading 1 is also called the H1 tag, it gets reserved specifically for the article's main title. This is the most important heading, which should provide a detailed overview of the content and include the target keyword. It is usually at the top in terms of hierarchy. A page usually contains only one <H1> tag.

Heading 2: Also called the H2 tag, it classifies your content into key topics or sections. These give the audience an idea of all the major points you will incorporate in the article. Use them as the outline's skeleton and to convey the search intent. H2 tags are seen as the next level down in the hierarchy.

Heading 3: Also called the H3 tag, these subheadings divide main sections into smaller subheadings. They offer specific information to support the H2 heading and make a logical flow.

Writer may also subdivide content with H4, H5, and H6 tags. However, writers don't need to emphasise these tags.

Conclusion: The conclusion holds everything together and reminds readers about the key ideas, leaving a deep impression while making the article's true intent stick in their minds.

Speaking to Persuade

Persuasion is the process of creating, reinforcing, or changing people's beliefs or actions.

1. Speeches on Questions of Fact
2. Speeches on Questions of Value
3. Speeches on Questions of Policy

1. Speeches on Questions of Fact: In some ways, a persuasive speech on a question of fact is similar to an informative speech. However, the situation for an informative speech is nonpartisan. The aim is to give information as impartially as possible.

The situation for a persuasive speech on a question of fact is partisan. The speaker's aim is to present one view of the facts as persuasively as possible.

There are 3 basic types of questions of fact: historical controversy, questions of current existence and predictions.

2. Speeches on Questions of Value: Persuasive speeches of value depend on a judgement that something is right or wrong, moral or immoral, or better or worse than another thing. The speech should include an appeal, criteria for judgement, and facts that support the appeal using the judgement criteria.
3. Speeches on Questions of Policy: the speaker's goal is to convince the audience that a given policy is desirable without encouraging the audience to take action in support of the policy.

Record Keeping

It is the maintenance of a history of one's activities, as personal, educational or financial dealings, by entering data in ledgers or journals, putting documents in files, etc.

What is the Importance of Record Keeping?

Good recordkeeping can be your proof that you have made considered decisions and taken appropriate actions. Records become your protection if you are questioned or challenged. Without them, you are at risk. Good recordkeeping can not only protect you but can support your organisation in legal or other challenges.

Businesses should also keep current and past employee names and addresses, time sheets, and paystubs. Generally, records should also include bank statements, insurance documents, contracts, loans and mortgages, purchase receipts, customer bills, profit and loss statements, and balance sheets.